

PATEK PHILIPPE CALATRAVA

8 SALLYING SMALL DIALS

After years of 42mm and 44mm dial dominance, smaller watches are returning with real authority. This is not simply a revival of vintage sizing, nor should it be reduced to a question of gender — it is a return to proportion. Watches between 34mm and 38mm allow the dial, bezel, lugs, and bracelet to work together more coherently, while sitting naturally on a far wider range of wrists. The Rolex Land-Dweller 36 and the 38mm Patek Philippe Calatrava Ref. 6196P demonstrate that smaller dimensions can feel entirely contemporary when the architecture is correct. The comeback is not a passing fashion but a sign that the market is rediscovering refinement.

JOHN GOLDBERGER



PHOTO: GETTY IMAGES

9 THE COOLEST COLLECTOR

Auro Montanari, or John Goldberger, has built one of horology's more personal collections, where great vintage Patek Philippes and Rolexes sit alongside contemporary independents and the occasional unexpected modern watch. His treasury of timepieces reflect a particular weakness for oversized chronographs and split-seconds from the 1950s and '60s. Montanari's books, photography, and public conversations have trained generations of collectors to notice condition, rarity, design, and historical context, and his collection is backed by scholarship.

PARMIGIANI FLEURIER'S TONDA



10 THE MICRO-ROTOR RENAISSANCE

With this resurgence, collectors have begun to understand that thinness is a complication in itself. Unlike a conventional full-sized rotor that sits above the movement, a micro-rotor is integrated within the calibre, allowing for a slimmer movement that reveals more of its architecture. Although not new, the idea feels relevant in an era when collectors want mechanical substance without unnecessary bulk. Parmigiani Fleurier's Tonda PF Micro-Rotor is one of the format's finest contemporary expressions at just 7.8mm thick. Its calibre PF703—only 3.07mm—uses a platinum micro-rotor. The attraction lies in what the engineering makes possible: better proportions, greater elegance, and a clearer view of the movement. ■

** All prices on request*